

General Knowledge

Static GK

STUDY NOTES

Olympics



Olympics

Origins and History

It Started in 776 BC in Olympia, Greece as a festival honoring Zeus. Only men competed, and events included running, wrestling, and chariot racing. French educator Pierre de Coubertin revived the Olympics in 1896 with the first modern Games in Athens, Greece. Initially, the only event was a foot race called the "stadion," a sprint over about 190 meters. Over time, additional events were added.

- **Pentathlon:** A combination of five events — a foot race, long jump, discus throw, javelin throw, and wrestling.
- **Pankration:** A form of martial arts combining boxing and wrestling, often with few rules, leading to intense competitions.
- **Chariot Races:** Races with horses and chariots that took place in the hippodrome, often causing spectacular crashes.
- It was held every four years over five days, during a period known as an Olympiad.
- Wars were often paused during this time in a **truce** known as the **Ekecheiria** to allow safe passage for competitors and spectators.
- By the late **4th century AD**, the **Roman Empire**, which now controlled Greece, adopted Christianity as its state religion under **Emperor Theodosius I**.
- He viewed the Olympics, rooted in pagan worship, as incompatible with Christian beliefs.
- **Final Games:** The last recorded ancient Olympic Games took place around 393 AD, before the official ban on "pagan festivals."



The Olympic Movement

- **International Olympic Committee (IOC):**
 - Founded in **1894**; the main body overseeing the Olympic Games.
- **Olympic Charter:**

- A set of rules and guidelines for the organisation of the Games and for governing the Olympic Movement.
- **Motto: "Citius, Altius, Fortius" (Latin for "Faster, Higher, Stronger").**

Modern Olympic Games

Olympic Symbol

- The Olympic symbol consists of five interlocking rings that are coloured **blue, yellow, black, green, and red**, set on a white background.
- These rings represent the five continents of the world: **Africa, the Americas, Asia, Europe, and Oceania.**
- The colours were chosen because at least one of them appears on the flag of every country participating in the Olympics, making it a symbol of global unity and sportsmanship.
- The design was created by **Pierre de Coubertin**, the founder of the modern Olympic Games, in 1913, and it has since become one of the most recognised symbols in the world.

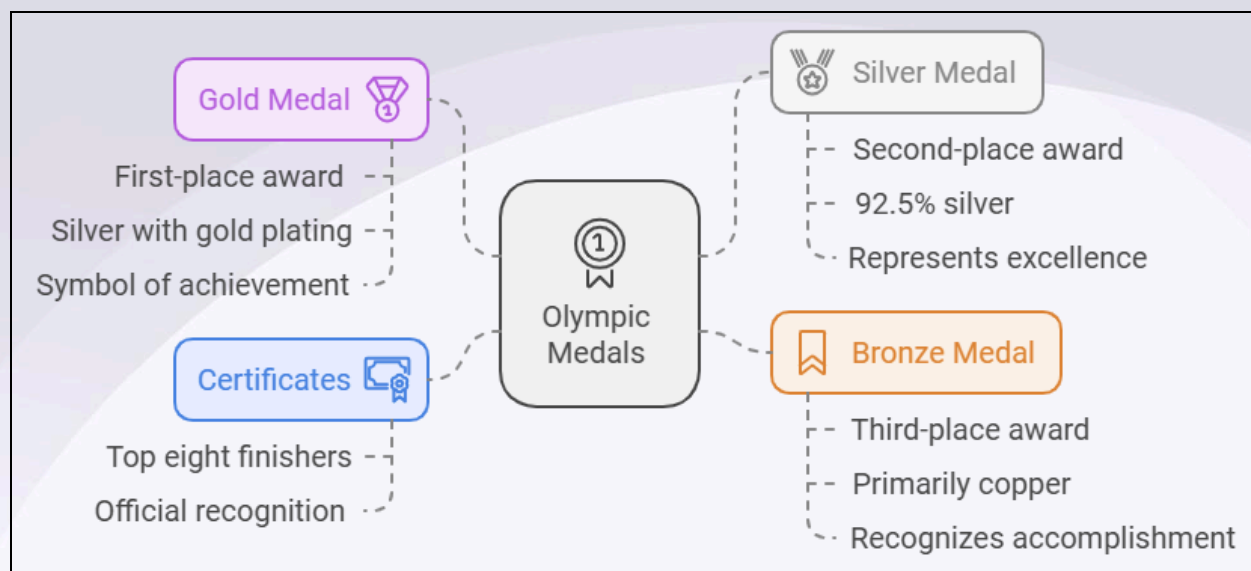


Olympic Flag

- The Olympic flag features the iconic Olympic symbol, which consists of five interlocking rings in blue, yellow, black, green, and red on a white background.
- The flag was designed by Pierre de Coubertin in 1913 and was first officially flown at the 1920 Antwerp Olympic Games.



Olympic Prizes, Medals and Certificates



Some Important Facts about the Olympics

- **Berlin 1936:** Known for Jesse Owens' victory and defiance of Nazi ideologies.
- **Tokyo 1964:** The first Olympics were held in Asia, and judo and volleyball were introduced.
- **1980 and 1984 Boycotts:** Cold War tensions led to boycotts by the U.S. and Soviet Union.
- **2008 Beijing Olympics:** Noted for its grand opening ceremony and China's rise as a sports powerhouse.
- The **Head Office** of the International Olympic Committee is in **Lusane (Switzerland)**.
- Participation of women in the Olympic Games started in the Second Olympic Games in 1900.
- Nilima Ghose was the 1st Indian woman to participate in the Olympic games. She participated in the 15th Olympic Games in 1952 in Helsinki.
- The International Olympic Committee was founded in 1894 at "Chakhon". Generally, in the inaugural ceremony of the Olympic games the team of Greece got first place and the host team was placed in the last in the March Past parade.
- The maximum gold medal winner sportswoman is Larisa Latynina
- She won 18 medals including 9 gold medals in a single edition of the Olympics.
- The maximum gold medal winner sportswoman is Christina Otty. She got 6 gold medals in swimming in the Seoul Olympics of 1988.

Types of Olympic Games

Type of Olympic Games	Description	First Held	Frequency	Organizing Body
Summer Olympics	Multi-sport events are held every four years and feature outdoor sports like athletics, swimming, etc.	1896 (Athens)	Every 4 years	International Olympic Committee (IOC)
Winter Olympics	A multi-sport event focusing on sports played on snow and ice, such as skiing and ice hockey.	1924 (Chamonix)	Every 4 years	International Olympic Committee (IOC)
Paralympic Games	International multi-sport event for athletes with disabilities, held alongside the Olympics.	1960 (Rome)	Every 4 years	International Paralympic Committee (IPC)
Youth Olympic Games (YOG)	This event will be for young athletes aged 15-18, focusing on education and cultural exchange.	2010 (Singapore)	Every 4 years	International Olympic Committee (IOC)
Special Olympics World Games	Focused on athletes with intellectual	1968 (Chicago)	Every 4 years	Special Olympics Organization

	disabilities, promoting inclusion and social acceptance.			
Olympic Winter Youth Games	Youth version of the Winter Olympics for athletes aged 15–18, focusing on winter sports.	2012 (Innsbruck)	Every 4 years	International Olympic Committee (IOC)

Indian Participation in Olympic Games since 1896

Date	Year	Place	No. of Countries	India's Performance
6 April 1896	1896	Athens, Greece	13	India did not participate (under British rule, no official team)
14 April 1900	1900	Paris, France	24	India participated in Athletics and Tennis; won 1 Gold (in Tennis)
25 April 1904	1904	St. Louis, USA	12	India did not participate officially
27 April 1908	1908	London, England	22	India participated in Field Hockey and Athletics; and won 2 Medals (1 Gold in Hockey)
5 May 1912	1912	Stockholm, Sweden	28	India participated in Field Hockey, Boxing, and Athletics; and won 1 Gold in Hockey

4 July 1920	1920	Antwerp, Belgium	29	India won 3 Gold in Hockey and participated in Athletics
14 May 1924	1924	Paris, France	44	India participated in Athletics, Boxing, Wrestling, and Hockey; and won 1 Silver (in Hockey)
28 May 1928	1928	Amsterdam, Netherlands	46	India won Gold in Hockey
30 July 1932	1932	Los Angeles, USA	37	India won Gold in Hockey
1 May 1936	1936	Berlin, Germany	49	India won Gold in Hockey
5 February 1948	1948	London, England	59	India won Gold in Hockey
17 July 1952	1952	Helsinki, Finland	69	India won 1 Gold and 1 Bronze in Wrestling and Athletics
30 July 1956	1956	Melbourne, Australia	72	India won 1 Silver in Wrestling
16 October 1960	1960	Rome, Italy	83	India won 1 Bronze in Wrestling
24 October 1964	1964	Tokyo, Japan	93	India won 1 Gold in Field Hockey
18 October 1968	1968	Mexico City, Mexico	112	India won 1 Bronze in Wrestling
26 October 1972	1972	Munich, Germany	121	India won 1 Bronze in Hockey

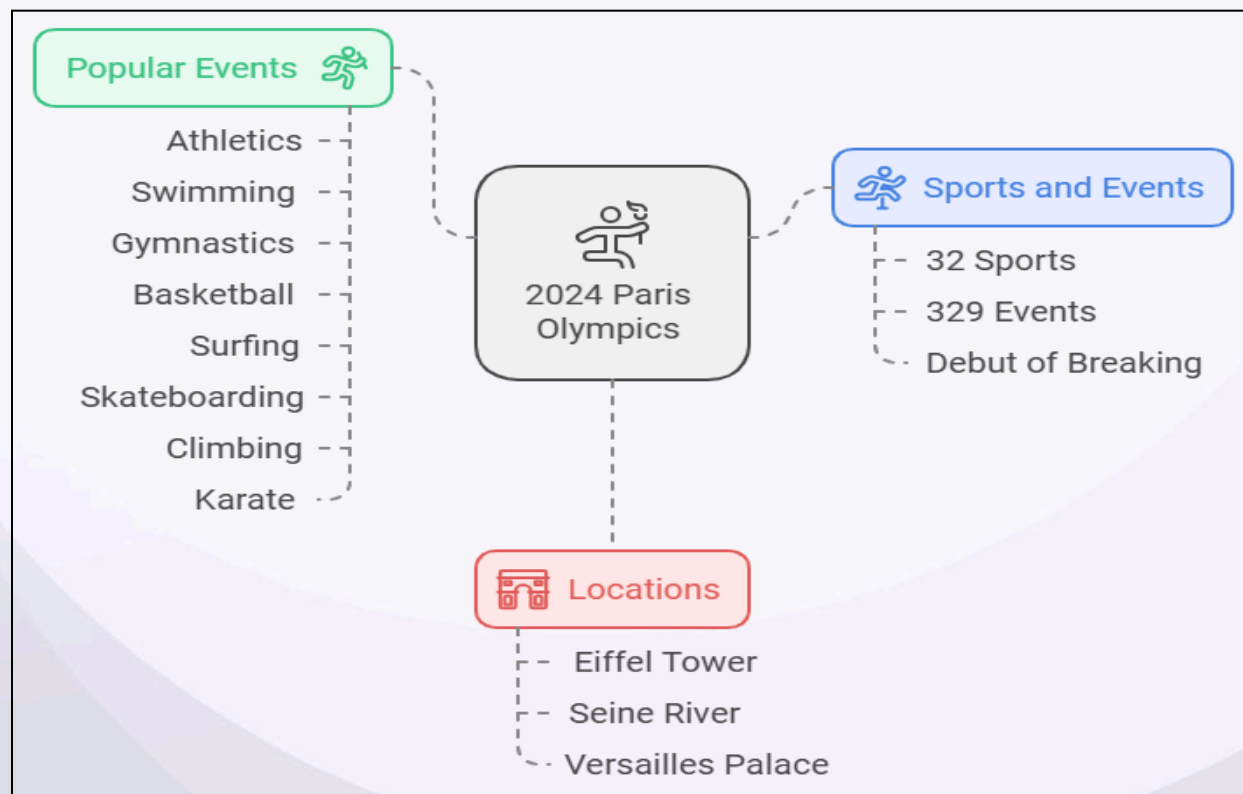
3 July 1976	1976	Montreal, Canada	92	India won 1 Silver in Wrestling
19 July 1980	1980	Moscow, Soviet Union	80	India won 1 Gold in Field Hockey
28 July 1984	1984	Los Angeles, USA	140	India won 2 Silver (1 in Shooting, 1 in Field Hockey)
8 September 1988	1988	Seoul, South Korea	159	India won 1 Bronze in Hockey
25 July 1992	1992	Barcelona, Spain	169	India won 1 Bronze in Field Hockey
19 July 1996	1996	Atlanta, USA	197	India won 1 Bronze in Field Hockey
15 September 2000	2000	Sydney, Australia	199	India won 1 Bronze in Hockey
13 August 2004	2004	Athens, Greece	201	India won 1 Silver in Shooting
8 August 2008	2008	Beijing, China	204	India won 3 Medals (1 Gold in Shooting, 2 Bronze in Wrestling and Boxing)
27 July 2012	2012	London, England	204	India won 6 Medals (2 Silver, and 4 Bronze in Wrestling, Boxing, and Badminton)
5 August 2016	2016	Rio de Janeiro, Brazil	206	India won 2 Medals (1 Silver in Wrestling and 1 Bronze in Badminton)

23 July 2020	2020	Tokyo, Japan	206	India won 7 Medals (1 Gold in Javelin Throw, 2 Silver, 4 Bronze in Badminton, Wrestling, Boxing)
July 26-August 11, 2024	2024	Paris, France	206	India participated and won 1 silver and 5 bronze medals

2024 Olympics

- The 2024 Summer Olympics, officially known as the Games of the XXXIII Olympiad, took place in Paris, France, from July 26 to August 11, 2024. This is the third time Paris will host the Olympics, following 1900 and 1924, making it a century since the city last hosted.

Sports and Events



Athletes and Teams

- Over 10,500 athletes from around the world are expected to compete, representing diverse nations.
- Spotlight on Eliud Kipchoge, the marathon legend, and other exceptional athletes in athletics and swimming.
- The Refugee Olympic Team participated for the third time, reinforcing the inclusive spirit of the Games.

Sustainability Goals

- Paris 2024 champions eco-friendly practices, with 95% of venues being either pre-existing or temporary.
- Commitment to a low carbon footprint achieved through green energy and extensive public transport usage.

Cultural Symbolism

- The official mascot, the Phryge, is inspired by the Phrygian cap, a historical symbol of liberty.
- The opening ceremony will feature a river parade on the Seine, presenting Paris's rich cultural and scenic charm.

India's Participation in the 2024 Olympics

Category	Details
Preparation & Support	- Target Olympic Podium Scheme (TOPS): Financial and infrastructural support for athletes. - Participation in international tournaments for qualification and exposure.
Cultural Impact	Reflect India's spirit of diversity and resilience, showcasing its rise as a global sporting power.

India's medal winners at the Paris 2024 Olympics

India won a total of six medals (1 Silver and 5 Bronze) at the event.

Athlete/Team	Sport	Event	Medal
Manu Bhaker(First Medal)	Shooting	Women's 10m Air Pistol	Bronze
Manu Bhaker & Sarabjot Singh	Shooting	Mixed 10m Air Pistol	Bronze
Swapnil Kusale	Shooting	Men's 50m 3 Positions	Bronze
Indian Men's Hockey Team	Hockey	Men's Event	Bronze
Neeraj Chopra	Athletics	Men's Javelin Throw	Silver
Aman Sehrawat	Wrestling	Men's 57kg Freestyle	Bronze

2024 Olympics Winners - Highlights

Sport/Category	Event	Gold	Silver	Bronze
Athletics	Men's 100m	Noah Lyles (USA)	Kishane Thompson (Jamaica)	Fred Kerley (USA)
	Women's Marathon	Sifan Hassan (Netherlands)	Tigst Assefa (Ethiopia)	Hellen Obiri (Kenya)
Swimming	Men's 100m Butterfly	Kristof Milak (Hungary)	Josh Liendo (Canada)	Ilya Kharun (Canada)
	Women's 800m Freestyle	Katie Ledecky (USA)	Ariarne Titmus (Australia)	Paige Madden (USA)
Gymnastics	Men's Floor Exercise	Carlos Yulo (Philippines)	Artem Dolgopyat (Israel)	Jake Jarman (Great Britain)
	Women's Vault	Simone Biles (USA)	Rebeca Andrade (Brazil)	Jade Carey (USA)

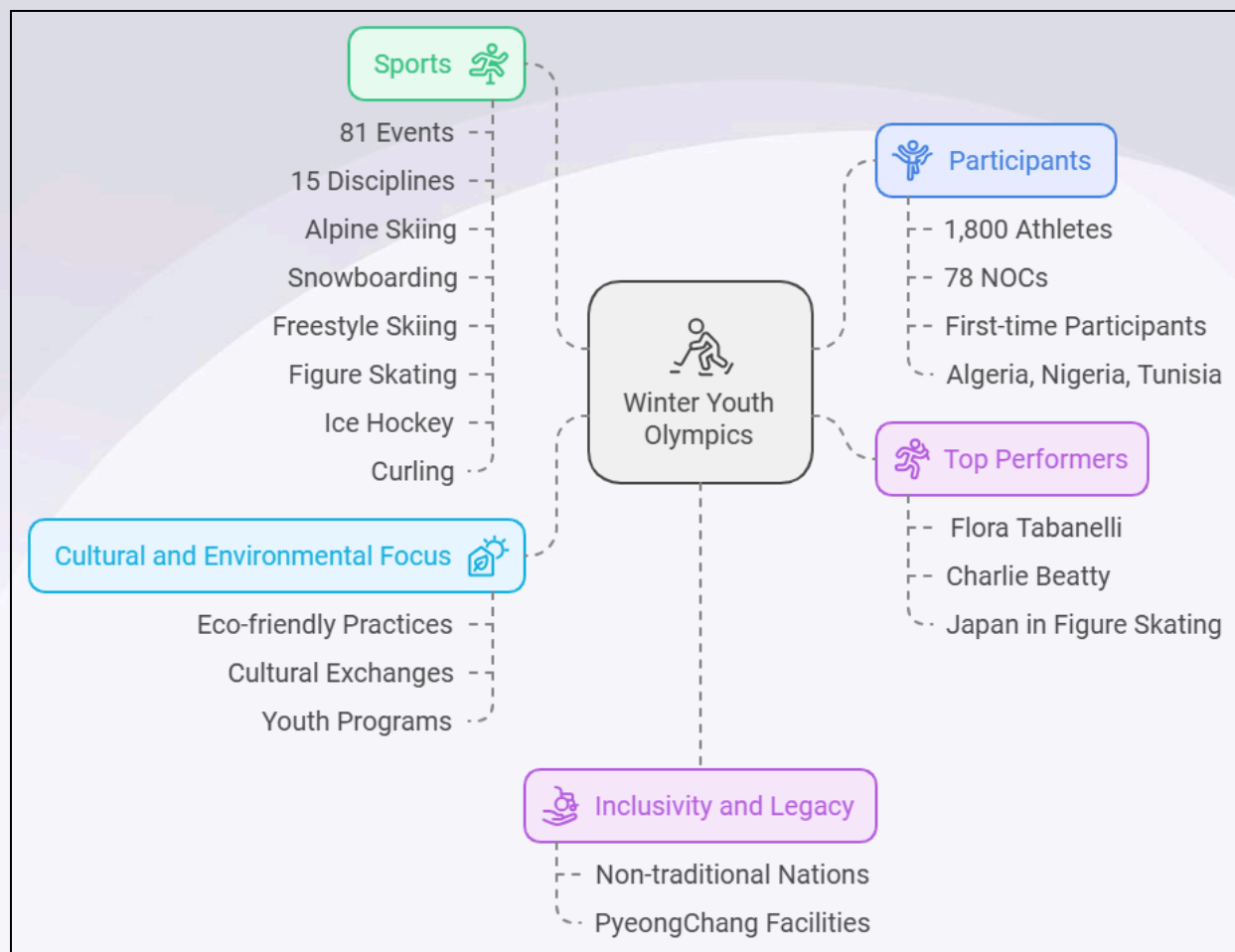
Sport/ Category	Event	Gold	Silver	Bronze
Tennis	Men's Singles	Novak Djokovic (Serbia)	Carlos Alcaraz (Spain)	Lorenzo Musetti (Italy)
	Women's Singles	Zheng Qinwen (China)	Donna Vekic (Croatia)	Iga Swiatek (Poland)
Basketball	Women's Team	United States	France	Australia

Top Medal Standings by Country

Rank	Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	United States	40	44	42	126
2	China	40	27	24	91
3	Japan	20	12	13	45

2024 Winter Youth Olympics

The 2024 Winter Youth Olympics took place in Gangwon, South Korea, from January 19 to February 1. These were the fourth Winter Youth Olympic Games and the first to be held in Asia. Over 1,800 athletes from 78 National Olympic Committees participated, competing in 81 events across 15 disciplines such as alpine skiing, freestyle skiing, snowboarding, and figure skating.

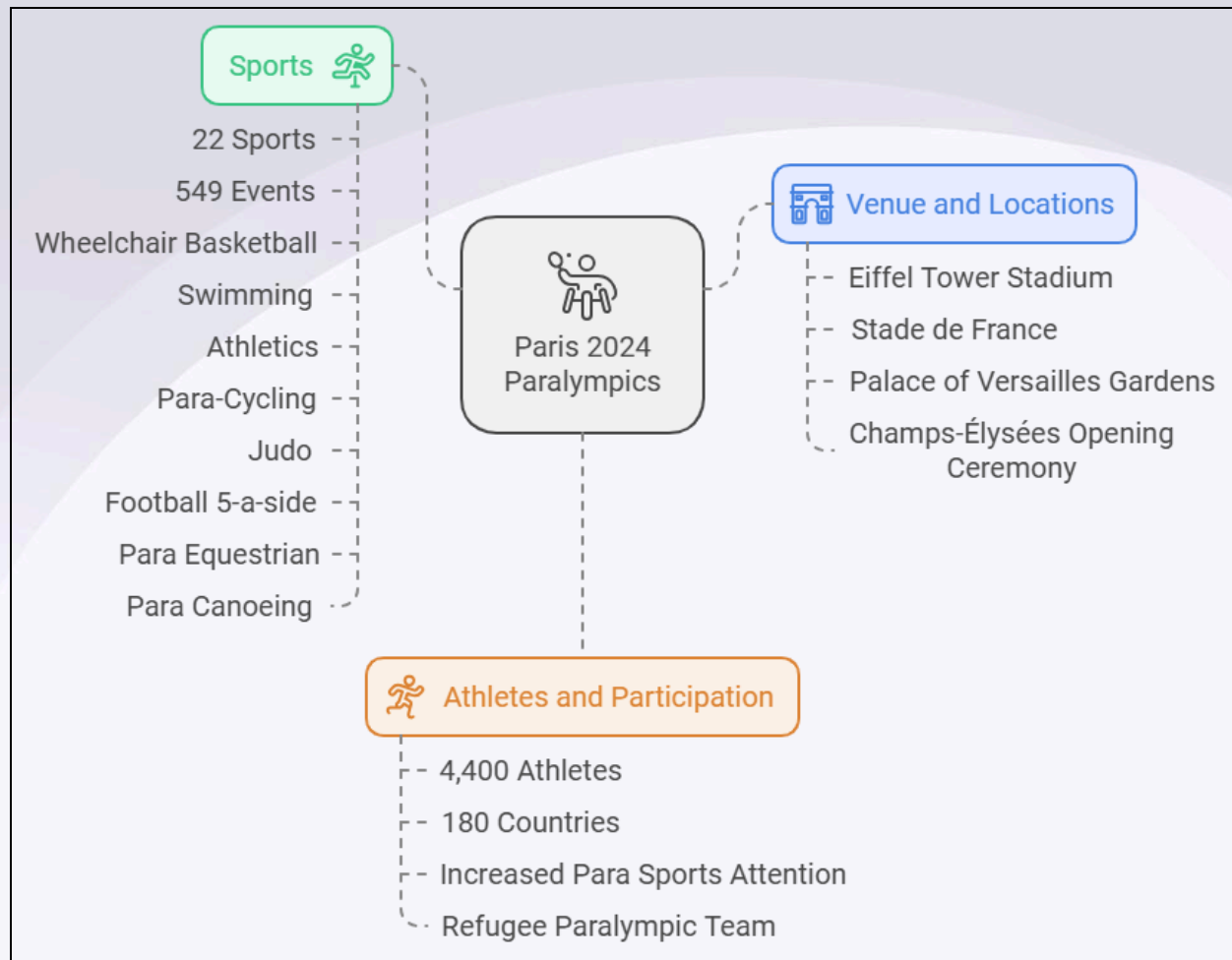


India's participation at the **2024 Winter Youth Olympics in Gangwon, South Korea** featured **Sahil Thakur**, a 16-year-old alpine skier from Himachal Pradesh. He was the sole representative for India at this event, competing in **alpine skiing** disciplines.

Athlete	Sport	Event	Performance	Medals
Sahil Thakur	Alpine Skiing	Giant Slalom	Finished 47th overall	None
		Slalom	Did Not Finish (DNF)	None

2024 Summer Paralympics

The 2024 Summer Paralympics will be held in Paris, France, from August 28 to September 8, 2024. This will mark an exciting and historic event, with a focus on inclusivity, sustainability, and innovation.



India winners in Paralympics Summer 2024

India had a fantastic performance at the 2024 Paris Paralympics, winning a total of 29 medals

Medal	Name	Sport	Event
Gold	Avani Lekhara	Shooting	Women's 10m air rifle standing SH1
Gold	Kumar Nitesh	Badminton	Men's singles SL3
Gold	Sumit Antil	Athletics	Men's javelin throw F64
Gold	Harvinder Singh	Archery	Individual recurve open
Gold	Dharambir Nain	Athletics	Club throw F51
Gold	Praveen Kumar	Athletics	High jump T64

Gold	Navdeep Singh	Athletics	Javelin throw F41
Silver	Manish Narwal	Shooting	Men's P1 10 m air pistol SH1
Silver	Nishad Kumar	Athletics	Men's high jump T47
Silver	Yogesh Kathuniya	Athletics	Men's discus throw F56
Silver	Thulasimathi Murugesan	Badminton	Women's singles SU5
Silver	Suhas Yathiraj	Badminton	Men's singles SL4
Silver	Ajeet Singh Yadav	Athletics	Javelin throw F46
Silver	Sharad Kumar	Athletics	High jump T63
Silver	Sachin Khilari	Athletics	Men's shot put F46
Silver	Pranav Soorma	Athletics	Club throw F51
Bronze	Mona Agarwal	Shooting	Women's R2 10 m air rifle standing SH1
Bronze	Preethi Pal	Athletics	Women's 100 m T35
Bronze	Rubina Francis	Shooting	Women's P2 10-metre air pistol SH1
Bronze	Preethi Pal	Athletics	Women's 200 m T35
Bronze	Manisha Ramadass	Badminton	Women's singles SU5
Bronze	Sheetal Devi Rakesh Kumar	Archery	Mixed team compound
Bronze	Nithya Sivan	Badminton	Women's singles SH6
Bronze	Deepthi Jeevanji	Athletics	Women's 400 m T20
Bronze	Mariyappan Thangavelu	Athletics	Men's high jump T63
Bronze	Sundar Singh Gurjar	Athletics	Men's javelin throw F46
Bronze	Kapil Parmar	Judo	Men's J1 -60 kg

Bronze	Hokato Hotozhe Sema	Athletics	Men's Shot put F57
Bronze	Simran Sharma	Athletics	Women's 200 m T12